

User guide

How to use StaffPilot: for everyone, managers, HR and payroll

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Contents

Getting started 4

Getting around . . . 4
Your account and security . . . 4
Your home page . . . 5

For everyone 7

Your profile and details . . . 7
Requesting time off . . . 7
Your payslips . . . 8
Clocking in and out . . . 9
Filling in your timesheet . . . 9
Claiming expenses . . . 10
Setting and tracking goals . . . 11
Your performance reviews . . . 11
Feedback and one-to-ones . . . 12
Company files . . . 12
Directory and org chart . . . 12

For managers 14

Approving time off and changes . . . 14
Asking for a promotion, job or pay change . . . 14
Your team's attendance and timesheets . . . 15
Approving expense claims . . . 15
Writing your team's reviews . . . 16
Goals, feedback and one-to-ones for your team . . . 16

For HR and admins 17

Setting up your company . . . 17
Company settings . . . 17
Users and access levels . . . 18
Adding and updating people . . . 19
Organization structure . . . 20
Setting up time off . . . 20
Approval settings . . . 21

Email alerts . . . 21
Onboarding and offboarding . . . 21
Company files and employee documents . . . 22
Training . . . 22
Benefits . . . 22
Reports . . . 23
Setting up attendance and timesheets . . . 23
Running review cycles . . . 24
Setting up and paying expenses . . . 25
Employee fields, record tabs and the directory . . . 25
Exporting your data and closing the account . . . 26
The audit log . . . 27

For payroll **28**

Setting up payroll . . . 28
Running payroll . . . 29
Payroll files and statutory schedules . . . 29
Loans and salary advances . . . 30
What goes into someone's pay . . . 30

Getting started

Signing in, finding your way and your account.

Getting around

Signing in, the menu, search and notifications.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Signing in

Your company has its own web address (HR sends it with your invitation). Sign in there with your work email and password. If you were invited, the email has a link to set your password first. Forgot it? Use **Forgot password** on the sign-in page and follow the link we email you.

If your role needs two-step sign-in, you are asked for a code from your authenticator app after your password. See Your account and security.

The menu

The menu on the left only shows what you can use. Depending on your role you will see:

- **Home**: announcements, who is away, birthdays and your shortcuts.
- **My profile** and **My payslips**: your own record and pay.
- **People**: the employee list, directory and org chart.
- **Performance**, **Expenses**, **Payroll**, **Reports** and **Files**.
- **My time off**, **Approvals**, **Attendance** and the **Leave calendar**.
- **Settings**, for HR and admins.

On a phone, the menu opens from the button at the top left.

Search

Press ⌘**K** on a Mac or **Ctrl K** on Windows, or click **Search** at the top of the menu. Type two letters or more to find people, files, reports and settings, then press Enter to open one.

Notifications

The bell at the top of the menu shows what needs you: requests to approve, decisions on your own requests, reviews to write and files to read. Most also arrive by email. Open the bell and choose **See all notifications** for the full list, or **Mark all read** to clear the count.

> You can stop some emails (not the in-app notifications) in Your account.

Getting help

The **?** button beside the bell opens the help article for the page you are on. From there you can search the whole guide.

Your account and security

Password, two-step sign-in, recovery codes, email preferences and calendar feeds.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **Your account** by clicking your name at the bottom of the menu.

Change your password

Enter your current password and the new one, then **Change password**. Other devices you were signed in on need to sign in again.

Two-step sign-in

Two-step sign-in asks for a six-digit code from an app on your phone each time you sign in, so a stolen password is not enough. Owners and HR can require it for everyone with admin access.

1. Install an authenticator app, such as Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator or 1Password.
2. On Your account, choose **Set up two-step sign-in**.
3. Scan the code with the app (or type the key it shows).
4. Enter the code the app shows to finish.
5. Save the **recovery codes** somewhere safe. Each one works once if you lose your phone.

Run low on recovery codes? Choose **Make new codes**; the old ones stop working.

Email preferences

You always see notifications in the app. Under email preferences you can stop the email copies for groups you do not need, such as time off requests, files to read, review reminders or expense claims. Messages about your security and sign-in are always sent.

Calendar links

See time off and company dates in Google Calendar, Outlook or Apple Calendar. Under **Calendar links**, choose **Make a calendar link**, pick what it shows (who's out, birthdays, work anniversaries, public holidays), then add the link to your calendar app as a subscription. Anyone with a link can read it, so keep it private. **Delete link** stops it working.

Your home page

Announcements, widgets, shortcuts and arranging your page.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Home is the first page you see after signing in.

What is on it

Home is made of widgets. Depending on your role you will see:

- **What's happening**: announcements from HR and new joiners.
- **Time off**: your balances, with a button to request time off.
- **My stuff**: things waiting for you, such as approvals and files to read.
- **Who's out**, **Celebrations** (birthdays and work anniversaries) and **Welcome** (new people).
- **Company links** HR has added, such as the handbook.
- For managers and HR: **Headcount, direct reports and turnover**, **Time off requests**, **Time off used**, **Pay raise**, **Certifications**, **Location** and **Onboarding**.

Arrange your page

Choose to edit your page, then drag widgets to reorder them, hide the ones you do not need, or add more from the drawer (department, employment type, gender, age, benefit enrollments and public holidays).

Only you see your layout.

Announcements (HR)

HR and admins post from the **New** menu beside the greeting (**New announcement**). Announcements show on everyone's home page. The same menu starts a new employee or a new report.

For everyone

Your record, time off, pay, time, expenses and reviews.

Your profile and details

What is on your record, what you can change yourself and what HR checks first.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **My profile** in the menu. Your record is split into tabs: **Personal**, **Job**, **Time off**, **Documents**, **Emergency**, **Training**, **Benefits**, **Assets** and more. Your company may rename, reorder or add tabs, and hides the ones you are not allowed to see.

Update your details

Choose **Update my details** on your profile.

- **Contact details**, such as your phone number, personal email and address, are saved straight away.
- Your **legal name, bank details and ID numbers** feed payroll and tax filings, so HR approves changes before they apply. Until then the change shows as **Waiting for HR**, and you can **Withdraw it**. If HR does not approve it, you see why on your profile.

Emergency contacts

Keep at least one emergency contact on the **Emergency** tab, so HR knows who to call.

Your photo

If your company allows it, click your photo on your profile and choose **Change photo**. Pick a JPG, PNG or WebP picture, drag it and zoom until your face fills most of the square, then **Save photo**; a bar shows the upload's progress. Otherwise ask HR.

Documents

The **Documents** tab shows documents HR has shared with you, such as your contract. If your company allows it, you can also upload files to your own record; they go into an **Employee uploads** category that only you and HR can see.

Job and pay

The **Job** tab shows your job title, department, manager, employment history and, if you are allowed to see it, your pay. Changes to job and pay are made by HR, or by your manager through an approval.

> Something wrong that you cannot change? Ask HR, or use **Update my details** and say what needs fixing.

Requesting time off

Making a request, half days, approvals, cancelling, and how balances work.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **My time off** in the menu. You see your balances for each type of leave, your requests and the public holidays ahead.

Make a request

1. Choose **Request time off** (on My time off or the Time off widget on Home).
2. Pick the **type of leave**, the **first** and **last day**, and tick **Half day** if you need one.
3. Check the number of days. Weekends and public holidays are not counted.
4. Add a **note for your manager** if it helps, then **Send request**.

Your request goes to your manager. Some leave types need more than one approval (for example your manager, then theirs); you can follow each step on the request. Some types need no approval and are booked straight away. You get a notification when it is decided.

Cancel a request

Open the request and choose **Cancel**. A request that is still waiting, or approved leave that has not started, can be cancelled and the days go back to your balance. Once leave has started, only HR can cancel it.

Balances

- Days are **earned** under your company's leave policy: all at the start of the year, or a share each month.
- Someone who joins during the year gets the share of the year that is left.
- Unused days may **carry over** to next year, up to a limit, and may expire after some months.
- Some leave, such as sick or compassionate leave, may be **granted case by case**, with no balance.
- The **ledger** shows every change to a balance: days earned, taken, carried over and adjusted by HR.

The leave calendar

Leave calendar shows who is away each month, by department, with weekends and public holidays shaded. Use it before you book to see who else is out.

> Your days are counted on the working days of your location. If a count looks wrong, ask HR.

Your payslips

Seeing and downloading payslips, what each line means, and loans or advances.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

If your company runs payroll in StaffPilot, open **My payslips** in the menu. Each payslip appears once payroll has approved and published that month's payroll; you get a notification when it does.

Reading a payslip

Choose a payslip to see its lines, or download the **PDF**.

- **Earnings**: your basic pay and allowances (such as housing and transport), overtime and any one-off payments. Together they make **gross pay**.
- **Deductions**: income tax (PAYE), pension, the National Housing Fund in Nigeria or SSNIT in Ghana, loan repayments and other deductions.
- **Expenses paid back**: approved expense claims. These are not pay, so they are not taxed; they are added to your net pay.
- **Net pay**: what is paid into your bank account.

The PDF also says what your employer pays on top, such as the employer's pension contribution.

Joining, leaving and unpaid leave

In a month you join or leave, you are paid for the working days you were employed. Unpaid leave, and unexplained absences if your company uses attendance that way, are taken off. Your payslip says so.

Loans and advances

If you have a salary advance or a staff loan, **My payslips** shows what is left to repay. Repayments are taken from each payslip until it is settled. Anyone leaving repays the rest from their last pay.

> Questions about a payslip? Contact your payroll team. Your bank details are on your profile under **Bank and ID details**.

Clocking in and out

Using My time, location checks, lateness and fixing mistakes.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

If your company uses attendance, open **Attendance** in the menu. **My time** shows your shift for today, a clock button and your last two weeks.

Clock in and out

1. Choose **Clock in** when you start. Your browser may ask to share your location; allow it if your workplace checks that you are on site.
2. The page shows how long you have been working.
3. Choose **Clock out** when you finish. You can clock in and out more than once a day, for example around a long break.

This works on a phone too: open the same web address in your phone's browser.

Location

Some offices have a clock-in area. If you are outside it, your clock-in is either marked **Away from site** or refused, depending on your company's rules. If your phone cannot get a location, allow location access for this site in your browser settings.

Lateness and overtime

- Clocking in after your shift starts (plus a few minutes' grace) marks the day **Late**.
- If you work longer than your shift by more than your company's threshold, the extra time is recorded as **overtime** when you clock out. It goes to your manager to approve and, once approved, is paid in the next payroll.

Forgot to clock in or out?

Ask your manager or HR. They can add or correct your time, and the day is marked **Edited**.

Filling in your timesheet

Logging hours against projects each week and submitting them.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

If your company uses timesheets, open **Attendance** → **Timesheet**. Each timesheet is one week, Monday to Sunday.

Log your hours

1. Use the arrows to choose the week.
2. **Add a project** for each piece of work. You only see projects you are allowed to log time to.
3. Type hours in each day: **7.5** or **7:30** both mean seven and a half hours. A day cannot go over 24 hours.
4. **Save** as you go. Totals for each project and each day add up as you type.

If you also clock in and out, a **Clocked** row shows the hours you clocked each day, so you can check they match.

Submit the week

Choose **Submit week** at the end of the week. It goes to your manager to approve, and you cannot change it while it waits.

If your manager **sends it back**, their note shows at the top of the week. Change it and submit again. If you find a mistake after it has been approved, ask your manager to reopen it.

Claiming expenses

Starting a claim, adding receipts, submitting and getting paid back.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

If your company uses expense claims, open **Expenses** in the menu.

Start a claim

A claim groups expenses from one trip or one month. Choose **New claim**, give it a name such as "Abuja client visit", then add each expense.

Add an expense

1. Choose **Add expense**.
2. Pick the **category**. Its limit, if it has one, is shown underneath.
3. Enter the **date**, **what it was for** and the **amount**. For mileage, enter the **distance** instead and the amount is worked out.
4. Add the **receipt**: on a phone choose **Take photo**; on a computer choose a photo or PDF.
5. **Save**.

Items are marked if they are **over the limit**, **over the monthly limit** or have **no receipt**. You can still claim an item over a limit; your approver sees the mark. An item that needs a receipt cannot be submitted without one, and expenses older than your company's limit (often 90 days) cannot be claimed.

Submit and approval

Choose **Submit for approval**. The claim usually goes to your manager, then to finance. You can **Withdraw** it while it waits. If it is **sent back for changes**, the note tells you what to fix; change it and submit again. A rejected claim cannot be submitted again.

Getting paid back

Once approved, the claim is paid back either **with your next pay** (shown on your payslip under expenses paid back, and not taxed) or **by bank transfer**, depending on your company. The claim shows **Paid** when it is done.

Setting and tracking goals

Goals, key results, check-ins and lining goals up with the company's.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **Performance** → **Goals**. You see your goals, your team's goals if you manage people, and the company's goals.

Set a goal

1. Choose **New goal**.
2. Write what will be achieved, with details if they help, and a start and due date.
3. Under **Supports**, line it up with a company goal or one of your manager's goals, so everyone can see how the work fits together.
4. Add **key results** if the goal can be measured: each has a start, a current value, a target and a unit (for example %, ₦ or customers). Progress is worked out from them. Without key results, you set progress by hand.
5. **Save goal**.

Check in

Open a goal to post a **check-in**: update the key results or progress, set the status (**On track**, **At risk**, **Behind**, **Done** or **Cancelled**) and add a note on what moved or what is in the way. Check-ins build up a history your manager can see.

Who sees your goals

You, your managers and HR. Company goals are visible to everyone and set by HR.

Your performance reviews

Writing your self review, peer reviews, and reading your manager's review.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

When HR starts a review cycle, you get an email and a task under **Performance** → **Reviews** → **To do**.

Your self review

1. Open **Your self review**.
2. Answer each question. Rating questions use your company's scale (for example 1 Needs improvement to 5 Outstanding); written questions are free text.
3. **Save draft** as often as you like. Only you can see a draft.
4. **Submit** when you are done. Every rating must be answered first, and you cannot change it after submitting. Your manager then sees it.

Peer reviews

Your manager may ask you to review a colleague. Only that colleague's managers and HR read what you write; the colleague does not. If you cannot give useful feedback, **Decline**.

Reading your review

When your manager has written your review, they **share** it with you. You then see their answers and your final rating. Add any comments and choose **I have read my review**. You never see peer reviews about you.

> Reminders arrive three days before a review is due and weekly once it is overdue.

Feedback and one-to-ones

Giving feedback at any time, and your one-to-ones with your manager.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Give feedback

Open **Performance** → **Feedback**. Pick a colleague, write your praise or advice, and **Send feedback**. They are notified and can read it.

Tick **Only for their manager** to send it privately: the person does not see it, but their managers and HR do. You can delete feedback you gave.

The page also shows feedback you have **received** and **given**.

One-to-ones

Open **Performance** → **One-to-ones**. Your manager plans them; you both see the date, **agenda** and **shared notes**, and you can both add to them. **Action items** can be ticked off by either of you, with an owner for each. Your manager may also keep **private notes** that only they see.

Company files

Finding policies and handbooks, and confirming you have read them.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **Files** in the menu for the documents HR shares with everyone: the handbook, policies, forms and templates. Browse the **folders** or **search files**, and sort newest or oldest first.

Files you must read

Some files ask you to confirm you have read them. You get a notification and see them on Home. Open the file, read it, then choose **I have read this**. The file then shows **You have read this**, and HR can see who has and has not.

Your own documents

Documents about you, such as your contract, are on your profile under **Documents**, not here.

Directory and org chart

Finding colleagues, their contact details and who reports to whom.

FOR: EVERYONE, MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **People** in the menu. Depending on your access you see the employee **list**, the **directory** and the **org chart**.

Directory

Search by name, or filter by **department** and **location**. Each person shows the work details your company has chosen to share, such as job title, work email, phone and who they report to.

Org chart

The org chart shows who reports to whom. Use **Jump to an employee** to find someone; the chart highlights the line from them up to the top. Hover a name for their details. **Export** the chart as a PDF or picture, or as a file for Visio or Lucidchart.

> If People shows **Turned off**, your company has switched the directory off.

For managers

Approvals, your team's time, reviews and one-to-ones.

Approving time off and changes

Deciding leave requests, pay and job changes, and handing over while you are away.

FOR: MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS

Open **Approvals** in the menu. The count beside it is how many requests are waiting for you. You also get a notification and an email for each one.

Time off

Each request shows the person, dates, type of leave, number of days and their note. Check the **Leave calendar** if you need to see who else is away, then **Approve** or **Reject** it. A reason helps when you reject.

Some leave types need more than one approval. After you approve, the request moves to the next manager up the line; where the line ends, HR decides. The person is told once it is fully decided.

Pay and job changes

Changes that wait for approval before they take effect, such as a promotion, a transfer or a pay rise, also appear here under **Pay and job changes**, in the order your company has set (for example manager, then HR, then finance). Approve or reject each one. A change with a future date takes effect on that day.

Away yourself?

Under **Hand over your approvals**, choose who covers for you and the dates. While you are away, they can approve or reject requests that are waiting for you.

> HR can tick **Show every pending request** to see and decide requests waiting for anyone.

Asking for a promotion, job or pay change

How managers ask for changes to someone in their team.

FOR: MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS

Open the person's profile and choose **Request a Change**:

- **Promotion…**: a new job title, grade or department, recorded as a promotion. Ask for a pay rise separately with **Compensation…**.
- **Job information…**: a new department, location, manager or job title.
- **Compensation…**: a new salary or rate.

Enter the **effective date** and a comment, then send it. It goes through your company's approval steps (set by HR under Settings → Approvals) and shows under **Approvals** for each approver. You are told when it is decided; nothing changes on the record until then.

HR can make these changes directly from the same menu, which also has **Employment status…** (for probation, confirmation, leave and leaving) and **Asset request…**.

Your team's attendance and timesheets

Who is in today, correcting time, approving overtime and timesheets.

FOR: MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS

Open **Attendance** → **Team**.

Who is in

The board shows everyone below you for a day: **In**, **Gone home**, **Not in yet**, **Late**, **Absent**, **On leave** or **Not working**, with their clock-in and clock-out times. Change the date to look back.

Correcting someone's time

Click a person to see their days. Use the pencil on a day to add or change a clock-in and clock-out, for example when they forgot to clock out. Add a note to say why. Corrected days are marked **Edited** and recorded in the audit log.

Overtime

When someone works longer than their shift by more than your company's threshold, the extra time is recorded when they clock out. It appears under **Attendance** → **Approvals** → **Overtime to approve**. Approve it to pay it in the next payroll, or reject it. Nobody can approve their own overtime.

Timesheets

If your company uses timesheets:

- **Team** shows each person's week: **Not started**, **Not submitted**, **Waiting for approval**, **Approved** or **Sent back**.
- **Approvals** lists weeks waiting for you. Open one to see the hours by project and day, next to the hours they clocked. **Approve** it, or **Send back** with a note saying what to change.
- Found a mistake in an approved week? Open it and **Reopen** it.

Approving expense claims

Checking receipts and policy marks, and approving, sending back or rejecting.

FOR: MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Open **Expenses** → **To approve**. Each claim shows the person, total and any policy marks.

Check a claim

Open the claim to see each item with its category, date, description and amount. Choose **View** to open a receipt. Items are marked when they are **over the limit**, **over the monthly limit** or have **no receipt**; a note at the top lists them.

Decide

- **Approve**: the claim moves to the next step (usually finance), or is approved for payment if you are the last.
- **Send back**: it returns to the person as a draft with your reason, so they can fix it and submit again.
- **Reject**: it is closed for good. Say why.

Nobody approves their own claim. Once a claim is fully approved it is paid back with the next payroll or by bank transfer, depending on your company's settings.

Writing your team's reviews

Manager reviews, overall ratings, peer input, and sharing the review.

FOR: MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS

When HR starts a review cycle, each person's review appears under **Performance** → **Reviews** → **To do**. The **My team** list shows where each review is.

Write the review

1. Open the review. Once the person submits their self review, you see it alongside.
2. Answer each question and give an **overall rating**. **Save draft** as you go; only you see a draft.
3. **Submit** when done. Every rating must be answered first.

Ask for peer reviews

If the cycle includes peer reviews, use **Peer reviews** on the review page to add colleagues who work with the person, then **Ask**. They are emailed. Their answers reach you and HR only; the person never sees them.

Share it

When the manager review is submitted, choose **Share with** the person. They can then read your review and their final rating, add comments and confirm they have read it. HR may adjust the rating during calibration before you share; the person only sees the final rating.

Goals, feedback and one-to-ones for your team

Setting goals for people, reading feedback about them and running one-to-ones.

FOR: MANAGERS, HR AND ADMINS

Team goals

Performance → **Goals** → **My team's goals** lists the goals of everyone below you. Choose **Set a goal for someone** to give a person a goal, and open any goal to check in on it.

Feedback about your team

On **Performance** → **Feedback**, use **Show feedback about** to pick someone in your team. You see all feedback about them, including feedback colleagues sent privately to managers.

One-to-ones

On **Performance** → **One-to-ones**, choose **New one-to-one**, pick the person and the date. You both share the **agenda**, **notes** and **action items**. **Private notes** are yours alone. Upcoming one-to-ones are listed first, with open action items counted.

For HR and admins

Setting up the company and looking after people's records.

Setting up your company

A checklist for the first days: company details, structure, people, leave and access.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Everything you set up lives under **Settings** in the menu. You only see the areas your access level can change. A good order for a new company:

1. **Company**: your name, logo and colour, time zone, currency, date and name formats, and sign-in security. See Company settings.
2. **Job organization**: legal entities, locations, departments, job titles, grades and teams. See Organization structure.
3. **People**: add employees one by one or import a spreadsheet. See Adding and updating people.
4. **Time off**: leave types, policies and public holidays. See Setting up time off.
5. **Users and access**: invite people to sign in and give them access levels. See Users and access levels.
6. Then, as you need them: approvals, email alerts, onboarding checklists, benefits, training, attendance, performance and expenses.
7. To run payroll here, switch on **Run payroll in StaffPilot** (Company → General settings), then see Setting up payroll.

> On any settings page, the **?** button beside the bell opens its article.

Company settings

Company details, general settings, logo and colour, and sign-in security.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Company**. Only owners can change these.

Company info

Your company's name (shown on the sign-in page, in emails and on reports), country code, currency for new pay records, and time zone (leave days, reminders and reports follow it).

General settings

How dates, amounts and names read for everyone, and what employees may do themselves:

- **Date format** and **Display names as** (preferred names can stand in for first names).
- **Show currency codes on amounts**: NGN 450,000.00 instead of ₦450,000.00, clearer when you pay in more than one currency.
- **Let employees change their own photo**.
- **Let employees upload files to their own record**: they land in an Employee uploads category the employee and HR can see.
- **Show expanded gender options**: adds Non-binary and a pronouns field.

- **Run payroll in StaffPilot**: adds Payroll and My payslips. Leave it off if you pay people elsewhere; expense claims are then paid back by bank transfer, and payslips already published stay readable.

Logo and colour

Upload a PNG, JPG or WebP logo (up to 2 MB) and choose your colour. They appear on the sign-in page, the menu and emails.

Login and security

- **Admins must use two-step sign-in**: everyone with admin access must set up an authenticator app. Set it up for yourself first on Your account.
- **Sign people out after** a period of no activity. Shorter is safer on shared computers.
- **Only allow these networks**: restrict sign-in to your office network addresses.

Data and account

Export everything your company keeps, or close the account. See Exporting your data and closing the account.

Users and access levels

Inviting people, access levels, field access, data scope, View as and API keys.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Users and access** controls who can sign in, what they can do and whose records they reach.

Invite someone

On **Users**, choose **Invite someone**. Enter their name and work email, choose their **access level**, and link **their employee record** so they see their own profile, leave and documents. They get an email to set a password. You can **cancel an invitation** that has not been used.

To stop someone signing in, turn off **Can sign in**. Their access ends straight away; their records stay. The list shows each person's **last sign-in**, and **Export** downloads it.

Access levels

An access level is a set of permissions, such as managing employees, seeing pay, setting up leave, running payroll or managing expenses. Built-in levels include **Owner**, **HR admin**, **Payroll officer**, **Line manager**, **Employee** and **Former employee**. On **Access levels** you can create your own, duplicate one to start from it, or delete one nobody uses.

Field access

For each group of fields (personal, contact, address, emergency, pay, bank and ID, custom fields) an access level says **None**, **View** or **Edit**, separately for **other people's** records and for the person's **own**.

Whose records

Each level reaches everyone, or only the person's own team, or only their direct reports. Under **Limit to part of the organization** you can also restrict someone to some legal entities, locations or departments.

View as

Use **View as** (the eye button beside a user) to see the app exactly as that person does, to check their access. It is read-only, ends after an hour, and is recorded in the audit log. Choose **Stop viewing** in the yellow bar to return.

API keys

On **API keys**, make a key for another system, such as accounting, to use your company's data. A key acts as the person who made it, with their access. Keys are **read-only** unless you choose **Read and write**. Copy the key when it is shown; it is not shown again. Delete a key to stop it working.

Adding and updating people

New employees, imports, power edit, job and pay changes, leaving and archiving.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Add someone

From **People**, choose **New employee**. Fill in their legal name, hire date, legal entity, department, location, job title, manager, employment type and starting pay. Their job history and audit trail start from the day they join. To let them sign in, invite them from Settings → Users and access.

Import many at once

From the **…** menu on People, choose **Import employees**. **Download template** (it has a column for every field, with notes), fill in one row per person, and upload it as Excel or CSV. Legal entities, departments and job titles must match the names under Job organization. Every row is checked first: if any row has a problem, nothing is imported and you get a list to fix.

Change many at once

Power edit employees shows a spreadsheet of everyone, so you can change a field for many people quickly, for example after a reorganization.

The People list

Filter the list, choose columns with **Customize view**, and save a filtered list as a **view** to come back to. **Export to CSV** or **Export to Excel** downloads what you see.

Job, pay and status changes

On a person's profile, **Request a Change** has:

- **Job information…** and **Promotion…**: dated entries in their employment history. A future date takes effect on that day.
- **Compensation…**: a new pay record. Earlier records stay in the pay history.
- **Employment status…**: probation, confirmation, leave and leaving. When someone leaves, record the **type of leaving** (voluntary, involuntary or other); it is used in turnover reports.
- **Asset request…**: equipment such as a laptop.

If your company has approval steps for pay or job changes, they wait for approval first. See Approval settings.

Change requests from employees

When people change their legal name, bank details or ID numbers, the change waits for HR under **Change requests** (and in your notifications). Check the new details against a document before approving: they go straight into payroll.

Archive a record

Archive record (in the **…** menu on a profile) hides a record from the employee list but keeps its history, pay and audit entries for reporting.

Organization structure

Legal entities, locations, departments, job titles, grades and pay bands, and teams.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Job organization** holds the structure every employee record points to.

- **Legal entities**: the companies that employ people, each with its country and currency. Payroll uses the country's tax rules.
- **Locations**: offices and sites, with their time zone and public holidays. For attendance, a location can have a **clock-in area**: its latitude, longitude and radius in metres.
- **Departments**: can sit under other departments.
- **Job titles**.
- **Grades and pay bands**: ranked grades, each with a minimum, midpoint and maximum pay. The **Pay bands** report shows who is outside their band.
- **Teams**: groups that cut across departments, such as project teams. Everyone can see them.

Setting up time off

Leave types, policies, carry-over, approvals, public holidays and adjusting balances.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Time off** has three tabs. Start with annual and sick leave.

Leave types

Each type has a name and a colour on the calendar, and says:

- Whether it **tracks a balance** (days are earned under a policy and drawn down) or is **granted case by case**.
- **Approvals**: none (booked as soon as it is requested), the line manager, the line manager then theirs, or three levels up the line. Where the line ends, HR decides.
- Whether unused days are **paid out on leaving**: added to the last payslip as part of the final settlement.

Inactive types cannot be requested; their history is kept.

Policies

A policy says how many days a year a group of people earns. Each employee gets the most specific active policy that matches them (by location, contract type and so on). A policy sets:

- Days a year, earned **all on 1 January** or **monthly**. Someone who joins mid-year gets the share of the year left.
- **Carry over up to** a number of days into next year, and whether carried days **expire** after some months.
- **Long-service days**: extra days after a number of years.

Changing a policy does not change the day count of requests already made.

Public holidays

Add the days everyone is off, for every location or just some. Holidays are not counted as leave days.

Adjusting a balance

On a person's **Time off** tab, choose **Adjust leave balance** to add or remove days, with a reason. It shows in their ledger. Use it for opening balances when you start using StaffPilot.

Approval settings

Who approves pay changes, job changes, time off and information updates.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Approvals** decides who approves what.

- **Pay changes** and **Job changes**: a chain of steps in order, for example the person's manager, then HR, then a named finance person. Waiting changes show under **Approvals** for each approver in turn.
- **Time off**: approved up the reporting line. How many managers approve (1 to 3) is set per leave type in Setting up time off.
- **Information updates**: changes people ask for to their own name, bank or ID details go to everyone who can change employee records, in their notifications and on Home.

Email alerts

Birthday, anniversary, probation and other date reminders by email.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Email alerts** sends reminders about dates on employee records, each morning, in the app and by email. Start with birthdays or probation ending.

Choose **New alert**, then:

- What it is about: **birthdays**, **work anniversaries**, **new starters**, a **monthly summary** of birthdays and anniversaries, or **a date on the record** (such as probation end, hire date or one of your own date fields).
- **Days before**, for dates: 0 sends it on the day.
- **Recipients**: named people, everyone with an access level, the person's manager, or the person themselves.

Onboarding and offboarding

Checklists of tasks for people joining and leaving.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Set up the tasks

Settings → **Onboarding and offboarding** holds the tasks copied onto a record when you start someone's checklist. Each task has a name, details, a category, who it is **assigned to** (HR, the manager, the employee, IT or finance) and when it is **due**, in days from the start or leaving date.

A task can apply to everyone, or only to people in some **departments** or **locations**. Tasks not **in use** are left out of new checklists.

Run a checklist

On a person's **Onboarding** or **Offboarding** tab, choose **Start onboarding** (or offboarding). Their tasks are copied from the list. Tick tasks off as they are done, and add one-off tasks with **Add task**. People see their own tasks on Home under **My stuff**, and the **Onboarding** widget shows who is starting and who has overdue tasks.

Company files and employee documents

Sharing files, read confirmations, document categories and expiry reminders.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Company files

On **Files**, make **folders** and **upload files** (PDF, Word, Excel, images or text). Tick **Share with employees** for everyone to see and download a file; otherwise only HR can.

To make sure people read something, such as a new policy, open the file's menu and choose **Ask everyone to confirm they read it**. Everyone is notified, and the file shows how many have confirmed.

Employee documents

Documents about one person, such as contracts, IDs, permits and certificates, are uploaded from their profile's **Documents** tab. HR sees them all under **Files** → employee documents.

Each **category** decides who besides HR can see its documents:

- **The employee can see these**.
- **Their managers can see these** (anyone above them in the reporting line).
- **Needs an expiry date**: for documents that run out. HR is reminded 30 and 7 days before, and on the day. **Expired or expiring** lists them.

Removing a document hides it; the file is kept for the records.

Training

The training catalogue, required courses and what is due.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Training** is your catalogue of courses. For each course:

- **Required**: shows as due or overdue for the people it applies to, and in the **Training due** report.
- **How often** it must be repeated, if ever.
- **First due, days after hire**: empty means no first deadline.
- Who it applies to: some departments or locations, or everyone.

People record completions in the **Training** table on their profile, using the course name. Each person's profile shows what is due soon or overdue.

Benefits

Benefit plans and enrolling people.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Benefits** lists the plans the company offers, such as pension, health and life cover: the type, provider, and what the employer and employee each pay (as a percentage of pay).

Enrol people from the **Benefits** tab of their record: choose the plan, the cover (employee only, employee and spouse, employee and children, family) and the start date. When cover stops, set its status to **Ended** instead of deleting it, so you keep a record. The **Benefit summary** and **Benefit enrollments** reports show who is covered.

Reports

Standard reports, custom reports, favourites and exports.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL, MANAGERS

Open **Reports** in the menu. **Recent** shows reports you opened; star a report to keep it under **Favorites**.

Standard reports

Ready-made reports, each with filters (dates, departments, locations and so on):

- **People**: Headcount, Additions and terminations, Employee turnover, Workforce make-up, Birthdays, Years of service, Job history, Missing data, Change history.
- **Pay**: Pay summary, Pay bands, Salary history.
- **Benefits**: Benefit summary, Benefit enrollments.
- **Time off**: Time off used, Time off balances.
- **Training**: Training due.

You only see the reports and columns your access allows.

Custom reports

Under **Custom reports**, **Build one** from any employee fields: pick the columns, filters and sort order, then save it. A custom report is yours unless you share it with the company (everyone who may see employee records).

Export

Every report downloads as **CSV**, **Excel** or **PDF**.

Setting up attendance and timesheets

Clocking rules, overtime, payroll links, shifts and rosters, and projects.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Attendance** has three tabs.

Rules

- **Switch on clocking in and out**: adds Attendance to everyone's menu.
- **Switch on weekly timesheets**: people log hours against projects each week; managers approve them. Works with or without clocking.
- **Grace (minutes)**: clocking in this late still counts as on time.
- **Overtime counts after (minutes)**: shorter extra time is ignored.
- **Overtime pay rate**: times the hourly rate, for example 1.5.
- **Pay approved overtime through payroll**.
- **Treat unexplained absences as unpaid days**: working days with no clock-in and no approved leave are taken off pay.

These two only take effect when your company runs payroll in StaffPilot.

- **Refuse clock-ins away from the site**: only where a location has a clock-in area (Job organization → Locations). Otherwise they are just flagged.

Shifts and roster

Everyone works **Standard hours** (9 to 5, Monday to Friday, with an hour's break) unless you put them on another shift. Choose **New shift** for other working hours, such as nights or weekends. To put people on a shift from a date, use the people button on that shift. A new roster entry ends the one before it.

Each person's shift decides when they are late, how much is overtime, and their hourly rate for overtime pay.

Projects

The projects and cost centres people log timesheet hours against. Each can have a code, client, **cost centre** and a **billable** flag, and can be limited to chosen people. Close a project to stop new time being logged to it.

Exports

On **Attendance** → **Team**, **Export project hours** downloads approved hours by project, person and day for the period.

Running review cycles

Templates, starting a cycle, following progress, calibration and closing.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Templates

Settings → **Performance** holds review templates: the questions and the rating scale. Every company starts with **Standard review**. For each question choose **Written** or **Rating**, and who answers it: **Self review**, **Manager review**, **Peer review** or several. The scale has 2 to 7 points, lowest first; managers also give an overall rating on it.

Start a cycle

1. **Performance** → **Review cycles** → **New cycle**.
2. Name it and choose the kind (annual, mid-year, quarterly, probation, other), the period, and the due dates for self and manager reviews.
3. Choose the template and **who is reviewed**: everyone, some departments, or chosen people (needed for probation reviews).
4. Choose whether it includes **self reviews** and **peer reviews**.
5. Save. Nothing is sent yet; check the number of people on the cycle page, then choose **Start cycle**.

Starting emails everyone. Each person's manager at that moment writes their review, so check everyone has a manager first: people without one show **No reviewer**. Reminders go out three days before each due date, and weekly once overdue.

Follow progress

The cycle page shows how many self reviews, manager reviews and shares are done.

Calibration

The **Rating spread** shows how many people sit at each rating, before and after calibration. In **Reviews and calibration**, adjust a rating that is out of line with similar work elsewhere, and give a reason. People only see the final rating once their manager shares the review.

Close the cycle

Close cycle when you are done. Unfinished reviews can no longer be written; shared reviews stay readable.

Setting up and paying expenses

Expense rules, categories and limits, and paying claims back.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS, PAYROLL

Rules

Settings → Expenses → Rules:

- **Switch on expense claims**: adds Expenses to everyone's menu.
- **Who approves**: the person's **manager**, then **finance** (people with the expenses permission, such as payroll officers and HR admins). Turn off either step. With both off, claims are approved as soon as they are submitted.
- **Receipts needed above**: receipts are only needed above this amount. Leave it empty to need one for every item, in categories that ask for receipts.
- **Oldest expense (days)**: older expenses cannot be claimed.
- **Paid back**: **with the next payroll** (added to net pay, not taxed) or **separately, by bank transfer**. Without payroll in StaffPilot, claims are always paid back separately.

Categories

Every company starts with Travel, Accommodation, Meals, Fuel and mileage, Phone and internet, Office supplies and Other. For each category set:

- A **limit per item** and a **limit per person a month**. Items over a limit can still be claimed; approvers see them marked.
- Whether it **needs a receipt**.
- A **mileage rate per km**, to claim by distance instead of amount.
- A **ledger account**, for the accounting export.

Paying claims back

- **With payroll**: approved claims are added to the next payroll as **Expense claims** and marked paid when that payroll is approved. If the payroll is cancelled, they wait for the next one.
- **Separately**: on **Expenses → All claims**, choose **Approved, to be paid**. Download the **Bank file**, make the transfers, then select the claims and **Record as paid** with the transfer reference. Each person is told.

Accounting export downloads every approved and paid item with its category and ledger account.

Employee fields, record tabs and the directory

Custom fields and tables, dropdown lists, arranging record tabs and directory settings.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Custom fields and tables

Settings → **Employee fields** → **Custom fields** adds extra details your company keeps on every employee, such as a uniform size or a staff ID. A **custom table** is a list each employee can have several entries in, such as certifications, assets or bonuses.

Dropdown lists

Dropdown lists are the choices offered for reasons, relationships and degrees, such as the reasons for leaving or relationships for emergency contacts. Add, rename or retire choices.

Arranging record tabs

On any profile, choose **Customize tabs**. Drag to reorder tabs and sections; built-in tabs can be renamed and moved, and your own can be removed. Changes apply to every employee's record.

Company directory

Settings → **Company directory** decides whether people see the directory and org chart, and which work details they show (such as work phone, email and location).

Exporting your data and closing the account

Downloading everything your company keeps, and what happens when you close the account.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Both are under **Settings** → **Company** → **Data and account**, and only owners can use them.

Export all company data

Choose **Export all data**. StaffPilot prepares one ZIP file in the background and emails you when it is ready, usually within minutes. It holds:

- **tables/**: a spreadsheet (CSV, opens in Excel) for every kind of record: employees, job and pay history, leave requests and balances, payroll runs and payslip lines, attendance, timesheets, reviews, goals, feedback, expense claims, documents, settings and the audit log. A **people_who_can_sign_in** file lists everyone's name, email and access level.
- **files/**: every stored file: employee documents, company files, receipts, photos and logos.
- **payslips/**: a PDF of every approved payslip, by month.
- **README.txt**: what each file holds and how the tables link together.

Passwords, two-step sign-in secrets, API keys and calendar links are never included.

Choose **Download** when it is ready. Each download link works for 10 minutes and is recorded in the audit log. The file is deleted after 7 days; make a new export if you need it again (up to five a day).

> Keep the export somewhere safe: it holds bank details, ID numbers and pay for everyone.

Close the account

Choose **Close the account…**, type the company name, enter your password and, if you like, say why. Then:

1. StaffPilot becomes **read-only** for everyone straight away, with a red banner saying when it closes. People can still sign in, read everything and download, and owners can still export.

2. Owners are emailed now, and reminded 7 days and 1 day before.
3. Any owner can **Cancel the closure** during the 30 days; everything then works as before.
4. On the closing day the account **closes**: nobody can sign in, and your company's address shows that the account has closed. The data is kept, hidden, for **one year** in case you come back. To restore it, contact StaffPilot; everything comes back as it was.
5. A month before the year is up, the owners are reminded. Then every record and stored file is deleted for good, logins used only for your company are removed, and the owners get a **deletion confirmation** by email to keep.
6. Encrypted backups that still hold copies age out on their own within about five weeks after that; they are never restored for anyone.

The audit log

Who changed what, and when.

FOR: HR AND ADMINS

Settings → **Audit log** records changes and sensitive views: record changes, pay changes, approvals, payroll actions, exports, downloads of bank details, and View as sessions. Search by name, email or summary, filter by area and date, and **Export this page** to CSV.

Entries cannot be changed or deleted.

For payroll

Pay groups, payroll runs, payslips and statutory files.

Setting up payroll

Pay groups, pay components and the salary split, statutory rules, and putting people in payroll.

FOR: PAYROLL, HR AND ADMINS

Payroll works for companies in **Nigeria** and **Ghana**, paying monthly or every two weeks.

Switch it on

Payroll is off until an owner switches on **Run payroll in StaffPilot** in **Settings → Company → General settings**. Until then, Payroll and My payslips are hidden and no payroll can be started. Switching it off later hides them again; payslips already published stay readable by their owners.

Pay groups

Settings → Payroll → Pay groups. A pay group is people paid together, on one schedule, from one legal entity. Make one for each legal entity and pay frequency, for example "Lagos monthly". Set:

- The **legal entity**. Its country decides the tax rules.
- **How often**: monthly or every two weeks.
- For monthly: the **first day of a period** and the **pay day** (the last day when a month is shorter). For every two weeks: the first period's start; later periods follow every 14 days, paid on the last day.

Pay components and the salary split

Pay components are the lines on a payslip.

- The **salary split** divides gross pay into **basic**, **housing**, **transport** and **other** by share of gross. In Nigeria, pension is worked out on basic, housing and transport, so set at least those three.
- Add your own **earnings** (adds to pay, such as a meal allowance) and **deductions** (taken from net pay, such as a union due). Mark each as **taxable** and whether it **counts towards pension**.

Statutory rules

Statutory rules shows the tax bands and contribution rates payroll uses, by country: PAYE, pension, NHF and NSITF in Nigeria; PAYE and SSNIT in Ghana. New versions are added when the law changes; past payslips keep the rules they used.

Putting people in payroll

Payroll → People lists everyone and their pay group. Select people and **Put in group**. For each person you can also set:

- **Pays NHF**, **Not in the pension scheme**, the **pension provider** and **NHF number**.
- **Annual rent**: in Nigeria, 20% of it (up to ₦500,000) reduces tax.
- **Annual life insurance** premiums, which also reduce tax.
- **Extra allowances and deductions** that repeat each period, from your pay components, with start and end dates.

Their salary comes from their **Compensation** record on their profile. Their tax ID, pension PIN and bank account are in their **Bank and ID details**.

Running payroll

Starting a payroll, checking it, approval by a second person, payslips and payment.

FOR: PAYROLL, HR AND ADMINS

1. Start the payroll

On **Payroll**, choose **New payroll**. Pick the **pay group** and **a day in the period** (the pay period that contains it is used). Tick **Off-cycle payroll** for an extra run in the same period, for back pay or corrections.

Payroll works out everyone's pay from their pay records, leave, attendance, expense claims, loans and payroll details. See What goes into someone's pay.

2. Check it

The payroll page shows totals (people, gross pay, deductions, net pay, cost to employer) and each person's payslip. Open a person and **Show lines** for the detail.

- **Check before approving**: payslips with notes, such as joiners, leavers, unpaid leave or someone with no pay record.
- **Net pay against the last payroll** flags people **new this period**, people **paid last time, not now**, and pay that **changed by 10% or more**.

Fix anything at its source (their profile, payroll details or leave), then **Work out again**.

3. Send for approval

Choose **Send for approval**. Someone with payroll approval, **other than whoever prepared it**, must approve it. They can **Approve**, or **Send back** with a note for you to change it.

4. After approval

- Download the **bank payment file** and statutory schedules. See Payroll files.
- **Publish payslips**: everyone in the payroll can see their payslip under My payslips and is notified.
- **Mark as paid** once the bank has paid everyone.

Approving also settles loans that are fully repaid and marks expense claims in the payroll as paid.

Cancelling

A payroll that is not yet approved can be **cancelled**. Approved payrolls cannot; use an off-cycle payroll to correct one.

Payroll files and statutory schedules

The payroll register, bank payment file, and PAYE, pension, NHF and SSNIT schedules.

FOR: PAYROLL, HR AND ADMINS

On the payroll page, each file downloads as **Excel** or **CSV**.

- **Payroll register**: every person with every line, for checking and filing. Available at any time.
- **Bank payment file**: who to pay, their bank, account number and net pay, with a narration. Available once the payroll is approved. Showing account numbers is recorded in the audit log. Check that everyone has an account number on their Bank and ID details first.
- **Statutory schedules**: what to remit, and for whom, with each person's ID numbers.

- **PAYE**: tax by person, for the state or revenue authority.
- **Pension**: employee and employer contributions, with pension PINs and providers.
- **NHF**: National Housing Fund contributions (Nigeria).
- **SSNIT**: social security contributions (Ghana).

> The bank file is a general layout. Check it against your bank's upload format before sending.

Loans and salary advances

Recording a loan or advance and how it is repaid through payroll.

FOR: PAYROLL, HR AND ADMINS

Payroll → Loans and advances lists every loan and salary advance, what is **still owed** and what is **taken each period**.

Record one

Choose **New loan or advance** and enter:

- The **employee** and the **type**: a loan or a **salary advance**.
- The **amount** and the **reason**.
- The amount **taken each period**.
- **First repayment in the period containing** a date.

The money itself is paid out outside payroll. Each payroll from then on takes the repayment from net pay until it is repaid. The person sees the balance on **My payslips**.

Leaving and early repayment

Anyone leaving repays the rest from their last pay. If someone repays outside payroll, record it so the balance is right, or close the loan.

What goes into someone's pay

Proration, unpaid leave, overtime, absences, expenses, loans and final settlements.

FOR: PAYROLL, HR AND ADMINS

For each person in the pay group, a payroll works out:

Earnings

- **Salary** from their compensation record, split into basic, housing, transport and other by your salary split.
- **Joining or leaving** in the period: they are paid for the working days they were employed.
- **Unpaid leave** is taken off, by working day.
- **Overtime**: approved overtime in the period, at their hourly rate (from their shift's hours) times your overtime pay rate.
- **Absences**: if your company treats unexplained absences as unpaid, those days are taken off.
- **Extra allowances** set on their payroll details.
- **Unused leave paid out on leaving**, for leave types set to pay out.

Deductions

- **PAYE** income tax, after reliefs (pension, NHF, rent relief and life insurance in Nigeria). In Nigeria, people earning the national minimum wage or less pay no tax.
- **Pension** (Nigeria: 8% employee and 10% employer, on basic, housing and transport), **NHF** (2.5% of basic), and **SSNIT** in Ghana (5.5% employee, 13% employer, on basic).
- **Loan and advance repayments**, and other deductions on their payroll details.

Paid back on top

- **Expense claims** approved and set to be paid through payroll. They are not pay, so they are not taxed or pensioned; they are added to net pay.

> Hourly pay is not supported yet: people paid by the hour need their pay entered as an allowance.